THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

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CLASS 10 — ENGLISH · HARD LEVEL FULL-YEAR PAPER SET 3

Full Syllabus (Chapters 1–28) | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 3 Hours Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 80**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–20 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 21–26 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 27–32 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 33–38 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 31–32 and Q. 36–38.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 20 × 1 = 20

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Which of the following supports the claim that Horace is not a hardened criminal? 1

(a) he sells stolen goods daily
(b) he steals once a year and politely helps a stranger
(c) he escapes
(d) he uses violence

2. Which is true of Griffin's character? 1

(a) he is both gifted and morally flawed **(b)** he is wholly good
(c) he is wholly cruel **(d)** he is a minor figure

3. Which concept links collecting and classification? 1

(a) taxonomy **(b)** geometry **(c)** poetry **(d)** trade

4. The phrase 'the fatal necklace' is an example of: 1

(a) foreshadowing **(b)** simile **(c)** alliteration **(d)** onomatopoeia

5. What is the effect of withholding Bholi's decision until the wedding? 1

(a) it creates suspense and a strong climax **(b)** it ends the story early
(c) it adds humour **(d)** it confuses the plot

6. Which sentence is an example of inverted third conditional? 1

(a) If the Martians understand, they attack.
(b) Had the Martians understood the book, they would have attacked.
(c) The Martians understood.
(d) Martians would understand.

7. The poem's brevity makes its message: 1

(a) wordy **(b)** slow **(c)** concentrated **(d)** vague

8. Frost's poem relies on which poetic device? 1

(a) epic simile **(b)** dramatic monologue
(c) extended metaphor **(d)** ode

9. The poem's closing image ends on: 1

(a) a death **(b)** a happy escape
(c) a rescue **(d)** an unresolved longing

10. The ending of the poem would be undermined if it: 1

(a) was short **(b)** rhymed
(c) had a title **(d)** gave a serious moral

11. The poem challenges the idea that: 1

(a) loss is real **(b)** children can grieve
(c) water is deep **(d)** everything lost can be replaced

12. A key irony is that Amanda's escape is: 1

(a) permanent **(b)** public **(c)** only mental **(d)** physical

13. A critic might note that the poem: 1

(a) rhymes strictly **(b)** has no symbols
(c) leaves the poet's own fate unresolved **(d)** solves all conflict

14. Which reading is plausible? 1

(a) The fog is a king
(b) The fog is a river
(c) The fog is a burning city
(d) The fog symbolises the quiet passing of time or moods

15. The poet's attitude to Custard is: 1

(a) scornful **(b)** hostile **(c)** affectionate **(d)** indifferent

16. The poem's implied question is: 1

(a) Who is Anne? **(b)** What is a text?
(c) Can anyone love without conditions? **(d)** Which colour is best?

17. Which word means 'easily convinced or cheated'? 1

(a) rational **(b)** cautious **(c)** sceptical **(d)** gullible

18. Choose the word closest in meaning to 'indivisible': 1

(a) small **(b)** inseparable **(c)** public **(d)** temporary

19. Choose the correct conditional: 'If the pilot ___ the black plane, he might have crashed.' 1

(a) had not followed **(b)** has not followed **(c)** did not follow **(d)** would not follow

20. Choose the sentence that uses 'incorrigible' correctly. 1

(a) The incorrigible sun rose.
(b) The incorrigible table was heavy.
(c) The incorrigible boy never stopped teasing.
(d) He was incorrigible after the medicine.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 6 × 2 = 12

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

21. Examine how the writer evokes sympathy for Horace despite his crime. 2

22. Examine the symbolic value of invisibility. 2

23. Evaluate how the writer makes scientific content accessible to students. 2

24. Analyse how the story challenges the idea that suffering ennobles. 2

25. Evaluate the claim that Bholi's transformation is believable. 2

26. Evaluate the effectiveness of satire in the play. 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) 6 × 3 = 18

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

27. Discuss how the story balances realism and idealism. 3

28. Analyse how the playwright uses dramatic irony to shape audience response. 3

29. Evaluate the significance of the poem's title. 3

30. Critically assess the claim that the poem is 'a warning in disguise'. 3

31. Critically examine the poem's use of contrast to build pathos. 3

OR

Examine how the poem uses the contrast of voice and content. 3

32. Critically examine the poem's treatment of consolation. 3

OR

Evaluate the effectiveness of the poem's two-voice technique. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) 6 × 5 = 30

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

33. Write a critical appreciation of 'Dust of Snow'. 5

34. 'Fire and Ice' is a poem of few words and large implications. Discuss. 5

35. 'A Tiger in the Zoo' is a poem of silence and suppressed energy. Discuss. 5

36. 'How to Tell Wild Animals' is a joke with a purpose. Discuss. 5

OR

'The Ball Poem' turns a child's small loss into a lesson in being human. Discuss. 5

37. 'Amanda!' is a poem about being heard. Discuss. 5

OR

'The Trees' is a poem of quiet rebellion. Discuss. 5

38. 'Fog' shows how little a poem needs to say. Discuss. 5

OR

'The Tale of Custard the Dragon' is a comic poem with a serious point. Discuss. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER Total: 80 Marks

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